

fertility rate and total fertility rate. An appreciable decline in age specific fertility of 24.1 percent was noted in the age segment 15-19 while a rather moderate drop of 12.1 percent was observed in the age segment 20-24. A small decrease of 5.7 percent was displayed in the age segment 25-29. These declines may be explained by reductions in the proportions married in these younger age segments. In the age group 30-34 a slight drop of 2.6 percent was observed while rises of 4.6 percent and 20.2 percent were in evidence in the age segments 35-39 and 40-44.

TABLE 7.4 : PROPORTIONS OF FEMALES WIDOWED AND DIVORCED BY AGE GROUPS 1946, 1953, 1963 AND 1971 CENSUSES.

Age Group	1946		1953		1963		1971		Legally Separate
	Widowed	Divorced	Widowed	Divorced	Widowed	Divorced	Widowed	Divorced	
15-19	0.6	0.2	0.3	0.2	0.2	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1
20-24	1.8	0.4	1.2	0.5	0.8	0.5	0.5	0.2	0.2
25-29	3.4	0.4	2.2	0.6	1.4	0.4	1.2	0.3	0.4
30-34	5.9	0.4	4.1	0.6	2.6	0.5	2.3	0.5	0.5
35-39	9.8	0.4	7.5	0.6	4.8	0.5	4.2	0.5	0.5
40-44	17.1	0.4	13.6	0.6	9.0	0.5	7.0	0.4	0.4
45-49	24.8	0.4	21.1	0.6	14.0	0.5	10.6	0.5	0.4

TABLE 7.5 : PROPORTIONS OF CURRENTLY MARRIED AND NEVER MARRIED FEMALES IN THE FOUR AGRO ECOLOGICAL ZONES - 1963 and 1971.

Proportion and Year	Age Group						
	15 - 19	20 - 24	25 - 29	30 - 34	35 - 39	40 - 44	45 - 49
<u>Zone 1</u>							
Proportion							
Currently married							
1963	7.7	43.2	72.6	84.9	88.2	85.1	82.2
1971	6.8	36.6	65.2	81.9	87.0	85.4	83.5
% Change	-11.7	-15.3	-10.2	- 3.5	- 1.4	+ 0.3	+ 1.6
Never married							
1963	92.2	56.3	26.6	12.8	7.5	6.3	5.3
1971	93.1	62.3	33.5	15.6	8.7	6.5	5.9
% Change	+ 1.0	+11.5	+25.9	+21.9	+16.0	+ 3.2	+ 1.7
<u>Zone 2</u>							
Currently married							
1963	29.0	76.7	90.6	92.2	91.7	85.7	80.7
1971	17.7	62.0	84.7	91.1	90.9	87.7	83.8
% Change	-39.0	- 19.2	-26.2	- 1.2	- 0.9	+ 2.3	+ 3.8
Never married							
1963	70.4	21.8	7.4	4.6	2.9	2.9	2.9
1971	81.8	36.4	12.6	5.2	3.3	3.2	2.8
% Change	+16.2	+70.0	+70.3	+13.0	+13.8	+10.3	- 3.4

* Wright Nicholas H. Recent fertility changes in Ceylon and prospects for the National Family Planning
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